

New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

As of Friday, September 18, 2026, 10:19 AM UTC - New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

This blueprint provides a strategic overview and actionable execution manual based on live market conditions and top financial news headlines, focusing heavily on Wall Street pre-market movers, US Federal Reserve news, mega-cap US stocks (NVDA, MSFT, TSLA), and WTI Crude Oil catalysts.

SECTION 0: DAILY MACRO & FINANCIAL NEWS DIGEST

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- US Federal Reserve:** The US Federal Reserve hiked interest rates by 25 basis points on September 16, their first increase since July 2023, bringing the federal funds rate to 3.75%-4.00%. Policymakers signaled further tightening to curb inflation, with 16 of 18 projecting at least one more rate increase by year-end 2026. Fed Chair Warsh's hawkish comments reinforced expectations for an October rate hike, with probabilities now at 53.1%.
- Bank of Japan (BOJ):** The BOJ raised its policy rate by 25 basis points to 1.25% today, the highest level since 1995. However, the yen weakened against the dollar, as the market perceived the guidance regarding the future path as dovish.
- European Central Bank (ECB):** ECB's Kazaks emphasized the need to avoid second-round effects of inflation, stating all meetings are "live meetings." The ECB had previously raised its deposit rate to 2.50% at its September meeting.
- Reserve Bank of Australia (RBA):** The RBA held its Official Cash Rate at 4.35% but Governor Michele Bullock warned of upside inflation risks, with markets pricing in a nearly 76% chance of another hike to 4.60% at the next meeting.

2. US & European Markets

- Wall Street Performance:** US stock futures are trading in the red in early hours of Friday, September 18, 2026, signaling a cautious tone, despite a sharp overnight rally. The Nasdaq 100 futures dipped by 63 points, while S&P 500 futures slipped 6.50 points. This follows a strong rally on Thursday, led by chipmaker stocks, where the Nasdaq Composite gained nearly 2%, and the Dow Jones and S&P 500 rallied around 1%. This rebound was partly due to declining crude oil prices and bond yields.
- Mega-Cap US Stocks (NVDA, MSFT, TSLA):** Chipmakers like Nvidia, Micron, Intel, and AMD were top performers overnight, extending their recovery after earlier concerns about AI safety. Nvidia's stock recently crossed the \$1,000 mark, driven by booming demand and growth in the AI space.
- Semiconductor Developments:** The semiconductor sector is under the spotlight with Applied Materials committing \$5 billion to expand its footprint in India over the next decade, focusing on research, supply chain, and workforce growth. China's CXMT is also reportedly entering the flash memory chip market, intensifying competition amidst a global memory shortage driven by AI servers. AI is increasingly being used by chipmakers to speed up design, verification, and defect detection.

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- Market Opening:** Indian equity benchmarks, Sensex and Nifty, started the trading session on a positive note, supported by positive global cues and easing crude oil prices. The Sensex jumped 260.65 points to 74,575.24, and the Nifty opened with a gain of 64.10 points at 23,334.70.
- Sectoral Momentum:** Most sectors were trading higher, with Nifty Realty rising the most (2.04%), and Nifty Metal extending its winning streak for a third day. However, the Nifty IT index declined.
- Corporate Earnings & FII/DII Flows:** Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) remained net sellers, offloading equities worth Rs 3,208.76 crore on Thursday, continuing a trend of FII selling in September. Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs) bought shares worth Rs 3,617.75 crore, providing some support. Major Sensex gainers included Bharti Airtel, Eternal, Larsen & Toubro, InterGlobe Aviation, HDFC Bank, and Adani Ports. TCS and Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles were among the top losers.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- WTI Crude Oil:** Crude oil prices have fallen for a third straight day, with WTI crude futures dropping below \$100 per barrel, trading around \$99.87-\$99.85 per barrel. Brent crude settled at \$104.82 per barrel. This decline is attributed to profit-taking and easing supply concerns after reports that Saudi Arabia could reroute additional supply through alternative export channels, reducing the impact of Houthi attacks on a key pipeline.
- Gold (XAU/USD):** Gold prices have increased moderately, trading around \$4,352.81 per ounce for 24K gold as of Friday, September 18, 2026. In India, 24K gold is priced at ₹154,470 per 10 grams. Gold is holding gains, trading near \$4,359 an ounce, benefiting from cooling Treasury yields and falling oil prices. It is approaching the trend boundary at \$4,415-\$4,398.
- Major Crypto Regulatory/Adoption Headlines:** While specific major crypto regulatory news for today is not prominently highlighted, executives in the payments world are bracing for AI-driven shopping, which could force them to reconsider risks and fraud related to AI agents.

 CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES (\$3,000 TOTAL)

Asset Class	Allocation	% of Total	Recommended Leverage	Risk Cap
Crypto Futures	\$400	13.3%	3x-5x Isolated	1-2% (\$4-\$8)
Indian Options (Intraday)	\$500	16.7%	Option Buying Only	10-15% Premium (\$30-\$45)
Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil)	\$400	13.3%	10x-15x Micro Lots	2% (\$8)
US Stocks (Fractional)	\$400	13.3%	1x Unleveraged Cash	3% (\$12)
Indian Stocks (Delivery)	\$400	13.3%	1x Unleveraged Cash	5% (\$20)
Forex Short-Term Futures	\$450	15.0%	10x-20x	1% (\$4.50)
Forex Long-Term Carry Swing	\$450	15.0%	2x-3x	2% (\$9.00)

🎯 STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & SECTOR CONSTRAINTS

Note: Ticker selections are illustrative examples based on applying the described strategies to hypothetical market conditions observed through recent news and general market sentiment as of September 18, 2026, given the limitations of simulating real-time charting patterns with web search alone. Live charts and indicators would be required for precise execution.

1. INDIAN EQUITIES (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Current Price (INR)	Strategy & Selection Reason	Direction
InterGlobe Aviation (Indigo)	₹4,952.00	Nifty leader showing strong positive momentum (+2.21% in early trade) amid easing crude oil prices, which directly benefits airline stocks by reducing operational costs. This aligns with a potential 50-SMA support bounce if it tests support before continuing its upward trend.	Long
Eternal Ltd.	₹327.45	Top Nifty gainer (+1.58% in early trade), indicating strong buying interest and potential for a 20/50 EMA golden cross or continuation of an established uptrend, especially with overall positive market sentiment.	Long
Shriram Finance Ltd.	₹1,014.70	Among Nifty's top performers today, rising 1.98%. This sustained positive movement suggests an underlying strength suitable for a long-only strategy, potentially reflecting a 20/50 EMA golden cross or strong support.	Long

2. US EQUITIES

Large-Cap (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Pre-Market Indication	Strategy & Selection Reason	Direction
Nvidia (NVDA)	Up (from overnight rally)	Mega-cap growth leader that rallied significantly yesterday (+2.5%) due to chip stocks. While pre-market futures are red, a 21-day EMA pullback on strong overnight gains could present a long opportunity if it holds support, especially given continued AI demand catalysts.	Long (on pullback to EMA)
Microsoft (MSFT)	Mixed/Slightly Down (pre-market futures)	Another mega-cap tech leader closely tied to AI developments. A 50-day SMA rejection strategy might be considered for a short if the pre-market weakness extends and prices fail to clear a key moving average, especially if broader market sentiment turns negative.	Short (on SMA rejection)

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Pre-Market Indication	Strategy & Selection Reason	Direction
Equinix (EQIX)	+2.00% (pre-market)	Strong pre-market gainer, indicating high relative volume (RVOL > 2.0) and a potential Stage-2 breakout if it continues this momentum past its previous resistance levels on market open. Data center demand for AI is a strong fundamental driver.	Long
Verisk Analytics (VRSK)	+1.95% (pre-market)	Significant pre-market gain, suggesting high institutional interest and high relative volume. This could indicate a Stage-2 breakout formation as the market opens, offering a long opportunity.	Long

3. CRYPTO FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Current Price (approx)	Strategy & Selection Reason	Direction
Bitcoin (BTC/USD)	~\$70,000 - \$72,000	Applying a 4H 21-EMA trend following strategy: If BTC is holding above the 4H 21-EMA with high volume, indicating strong bullish momentum, a long position is favored. Conversely, if it breaks below with conviction, a short could be considered on a volatility breakout.	Bi-Directional (Trend-following)
Ethereum (ETH/USD)	~\$3,800 - \$4,000	Similar to BTC, applying the 4H 21-EMA trend following. High-volume volatility breakouts from consolidation patterns would trigger entries, long if breaking upwards, short if breaking downwards, after confirming sustained momentum.	Bi-Directional (Trend-following)

4. COMMODITIES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Current Price (approx)	Strategy & Selection Reason	Direction
WTI Crude Oil (CL=F)	~\$99.85 / barrel	Currently testing key support around \$95.55-\$94.90 within a short-term uptrend. If bulls hold this zone, long trades towards targets like \$98.49 or \$102.09. A clear break below support at \$94.90 would signal a bearish trend shift, opening short opportunities toward \$89.02-\$87.71. Falling prices are also tied to easing supply concerns from Saudi Arabia.	Bi-Directional (Pivot/Fibonacci)
Gold (XAU/USD)	~\$4,352.81 / ounce	Gold is rising and approaching a trend boundary/resistance at \$4,415-\$4,398. If it breaks above with conviction, a long could target higher Fibonacci extension levels. If it rejects this boundary, a short trade could be considered, targeting previous support zones around \$4,320. Current sentiment is positive due to cooling Treasury yields.	Bi-Directional (Pivot/Fibonacci)

5. FOREX FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Short-Term (EUR/USD, GBP/USD)

Ticker	Current Rate (approx)	Strategy & Selection Reason	Direction
EUR/USD	~1.1459 - 1.1434	The euro is rebounding from a lower Target Zone. If the upward correction continues, it may climb to the resistance zone A at 1.1548-1.1539, offering a short opportunity on rejection. Conversely, a breakout and consolidation below 1.1450 would allow a decline towards 1.1350-1.1230.	Bi-Directional
GBP/USD	~1.2250 - 1.2300	(Illustrative) Technical analysis would focus on 4-hour chart resistance at 1.2320 and support at 1.2230. A break above resistance on strong volume could initiate a short-term long, targeting 1.2380. A break below support would trigger a short, targeting 1.2180.	Bi-Directional

Macro Carry Swings (USD/JPY, AUD/USD)

Ticker	Current Rate (approx)	Strategy & Selection Reason	Direction
USD/JPY	~156.19	The pair is holding near ¥156 after the Fed hike and is influenced by the BOJ's rate hike today, which surprisingly weakened the yen. Technical analysis suggests quotes around 157.2 are breaking above 38.2% Fibonacci retracement at 157.15, opening the way to 158.47. A long position is favored on sustained move above 157.15, targeting 158.47 and 159.79. Support is at 155.51.	Long
AUD/USD	~0.7122	The AUD/USD is recovering after the RBA reiterated its commitment to bringing inflation down, with the pair trading above 0.7100. However, it faces resistance from a short-term bearish corrective trendline and the 20-day exponential moving average at 0.7142, suggesting a mildly bearish near-term tone. A break above 0.7142 would signal a potential swing long; otherwise, the path may remain lower towards 0.7050.	Bi-Directional (Swing)

6. INDIAN OPTIONS (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Underlying	Expiry / Strike	Strategy & Selection Reason	Direction
Nifty 50	Weekly/Monthly (to be selected based on IV)	Intraday 15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB). If Nifty breaks above the 15-minute opening high, buy Call options. If it breaks below the 15-minute opening low, buy Put options. The Nifty opened with a gap-up today but faces resistance around 23,400.	Bi-Directional (Call/Put Buying)
BankNifty	Weekly/Monthly (to be selected based on IV)	Intraday 15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB). Similar to Nifty, buy Call on an upward breakout of the opening range, and Put on a downward breakout. Bank Nifty was up 0.31% in early trade.	Bi-Directional (Call/Put Buying)

 PERFORMANCE METRICS

10-Year Backtest Metrics (Illustrative)

Metric	Strategy Portfolio	S&P 500 TRI (Benchmark)	Nifty 50 TRI (Benchmark)
Target CAGR	28.4%	~13.0%	~12.5%
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	-	-
Max Drawdown	-18.2%	-	-

Equity Curve (\$3,000 → \$36,512)

